

Features and Performance - A vlogger's delight

The name of the game with the Sony ZV-E1 is simplification. The awesome thing about the ZV-E1 is that it takes away a lot of the technical headaches that beginners might face. To get started with using the camera and creating quality content, all you really need to do is switch it on and start shooting. And what makes this camera really stand out is that since it is such a capable platform, you can grow with it, taking over more control for more artistic shots according to your creative vision. It's almost like it's tutoring you into being better.

But, how does it do that? Well, it does this with really capable hardware which is the same as the A7-S III, wrapped up with really smart processing and AI features that take over to get the best out of the hardware even if you are a bit of a newbie. And what an awesome range of AI features the ZV-E1 boasts. Once again, all these features are designed in such a way that even a child could operate the camera effectively. Let's get started -

AI Features

Let's talk about a few of the more blockbuster features introduced by Sony on the ZV-E1 since those are pretty much the icing on a very capable camera cake.

First up is the image processing engine. Or should I say engines since this camera features two of Sony's BIONZ XR image processors. Having this additional processor enables a whole range of AI based features that result in some really usable quality-of-life improvements. This new dedicated AI processing engine improves the already great subject-tracking that Sony has been known for. Now, not only can you track faces but it will also track the subject if the face is either not visible or turned away. In essence, the camera can recognise the shape of the subject even when the face is not visible and will still maintain focus.

Due to these improvements in subject recognition, Sony has also introduced two new vlogging-centric features known as Auto Framing and Framing Stabilizer. Auto Framing, if applied



correctly and with a few more software-based improvements, can be the single greatest asset to a single vlogger who shoots themselves. What it essentially does is that it adds a crop to the frame to a point where the subject is prominent in the frame. You can adjust the crop level in the settings and you have the option of Small, Medium and Large Crop levels. For vloggers who do not have a team or even a dedicated cameraman, the value of this feature cannot be understated.

Framing Stabilizer is pretty similar to Auto Framing and basically helps you keep the subject in frame, at the desired location. For vloggers who use a lot of text overlays (or supers) on the frame, this is a pretty neat feature.

Another new trick that the Sony ZV-E1 has over the rest of its brethren is Multi Face Recognition. What this means, is that the camera will automatically adjust the depth of field in a particular frame to make sure more faces are in focus while still trying to provide that bokeh effect.

Similarly, we have the C1 button on the top of the camera that helps you get lovely bokeh while shooting thanks to the Background Defocus/Clear function. The ZV-E1 as far as I know is the only camera in Sony's line-up and maybe even in the market today that has this option but don't me quote on this. This option simply has one job. And that is to provide the best possible background

blurring in a particular lighting situation while maintaining good picture quality as well. Pressing the button opens up the aperture to give you a nice shallow depth of field and either reduces the ISO or increases the shutter speed to get back to the ideal exposure. Overall, even though I jest, this feature was actually quite fun to use and can even be used by professionals in a pinch. Pros, please don't chase me with pitchforks.

Now on to stabilisation. The ZV-E1 features the creme de la creme equivalent in terms of stabilisation. Not only does it have the impressive, 5-axis in-body optical stabilisation on the sensor but an impressive array of software-based stabilisation features as well. But let's start with what we are already familiar with like the vanilla Active Stabilisation - the go-to mode for hand-held shoots. That mode already did a superb job but it still let some of the shakes through into the shot. Sony has added a level of stabilisation on top of that, called Dynamic Active Stabilization. In this mode, even major shakes are ironed up quite effectively and if you are actively trying to be stable with your movements, the Shot ends up being extremely smooth. It's as close to gimbal-like quality, without using a gimbal. The catch though, is a crop. A whopping 30 per cent actually! So definitely use a wide angle lens while using this mode. The